

# Journal Prompts

Cynthia's six prompts, a three-entry template, and the pattern review · Module 4, Training 3

## How to write

10–15 minutes · by hand if you can · no editing · for no one but you. Three entries this week (50 XP). Expressive writing improves psychological and physical health (Pennebaker & Beall, *Journal of Abnormal Psychology*; Smyth, *Journal of Consulting and Clinical Psychology*; Baikie & Wilhelm, *Advances in Psychiatric Treatment*). Naming an emotion precisely reduces activity in the brain's alarm centre (Lieberman et al., *Psychological Science*).

## The prompts

| # | PROMPT                                        | START WITH...                                         | THEN                                                                                                       |
|---|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>My big why</b> (do this first)             | "I want this family because..."                       | write it as if explaining to the child; reread when motivation drops                                       |
| 2 | <b>Fears</b>                                  | "I'm afraid that..."                                  | list until the pen slows; mark each: in my control <input type="checkbox"/> / not <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 3 | <b>Hope and impatience</b>                    | a paragraph in Hope's voice, then one in Impatience's | let each be heard; notice which softens                                                                    |
| 4 | <b>Three gratitudes</b>                       | "Today I'm grateful for..."                           | specific, not general ("the way you put my tea down without a word")                                       |
| 5 | <b>Right now I feel...</b>                    | choose the closest word on the wheel (T5)             | write from that word, not from "stressed"                                                                  |
| 6 | <b>A letter to my future child</b> (optional) | "Before you were here, I want you to know..."         | not about the trying; about the two of you. It can wait.                                                   |

## Mini emotion wheel (full wheel in Training 5)

| CORE    | FINER WORDS                                                       |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Joy     | grateful · hopeful · proud · tender · playful · relieved          |
| Sadness | disappointed · lonely · hollow · grieving · weary · wistful       |
| Fear    | anxious · powerless · overwhelmed · insecure · dreading · fragile |









## Pattern review (30 XP) — read your entries beside your M1 craving log, M2 mood/energy tracker and M3 sleep log

| LINK I NOTICED                       | EXAMPLE FROM MY LOGS                             | ONE LEVER I'LL PULL THIS WEEK     |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| e.g. cravings ↔ unprocessed conflict | "Chocolate at 9 p.m. on the day of the argument" | one sigh + walk before the pantry |
|                                      |                                                  |                                   |
|                                      |                                                  |                                   |
|                                      |                                                  |                                   |

The one link I'll act on this week: \_\_\_\_\_

Fears in my control: \_\_\_\_\_ Not in my control (I can put these down): \_\_\_\_\_

## Share an insight (20 XP)

Post one sentence in the forum, anonymously if you prefer. Suggested opener: "Journaling showed me that \_\_\_\_\_."

## Partners

Your journal is yours; don't read each other's. Share one line at the weekly check-in if you wish. Many couples reread their big-why entries together on hard days.

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Educational content only, not medical advice. Always consult your doctor or a qualified health professional before changing supplements, diet, exercise or detox practices, especially while trying to conceive.